

They booked. Now make sure they turn up.

• WHAT WE ARE PROPOSING, IN ONE SENTENCE

Five messages in the five weeks between a student booking your open day and the morning of the event. Four emails and one text.

You have a big audience, and none of it points at the open day.

Views on the nineteen videos showing on your TikTok profile, read against the views on the open day film you made for this exact job.

2.51m

Views on 19 TikTok videos

Four videos carry 96% of that total.

1.2m

Views on your biggest one

The largest audience Middlesex gathers all year.

4,569

TikTok followers

About 549 views for every follower you have.

185

Views on "Open Day: What to Expect"

On YouTube, where your last 12 uploads averaged 694.

Your social content is good

These captions come off your own grid. They read as fluent and native, written by people who understand the platform:

- "Slay king ✨ #MiddlesexUni #CampusTour #GenZ #UniTok"
- "Rate the gym outfit 💪 The student off peak pass is only £60 a year?"
- "Brand new term loading 📖 ⌚ "

The audience is already yours. No video on that grid links to the open day booking page, and the link in your bio does not go there either.

The open day is well built. The confirmation page passes on one sentence.

Your schedule page for Sunday 18 October publishes real, useful detail. This is how much of that detail reaches the person who has just booked a place.

What your schedule page says

- Welcome talks at 10am and 12pm, in rooms CG77 and CG76
- UCAS and personal statements at 12.30pm
- Accommodation at 1pm, student finance at 1.30pm
- Library tours at 12, 12.30, 1 and 1.30
- Doors open 9.30am, parking on site, ten minutes from the Northern Line

Each subject session carries a hands-on element, one to one time with lecturers, faculty zones and student-led tours of the halls. Somebody at Middlesex did careful work here.

What the person who booked gets instead

"We will be in touch with further information on the event nearer the time, keep an eye out in your inbox."

mdx.ac.uk/about-us/events/undergraduate-open-day/thank-you/

That page also offers a virtual tour, a campus film and a chat with a current student, all of it good. It all arrives in the ten seconds after they hit submit, when the day is five weeks away and they are not planning anything yet.

They still need a schedule for their subject, an arrival time, a calendar file and something written to whoever is driving them. The page carries none of that.

The day itself is strong. The person who booked it will not meet any of that careful work until they are standing on campus.

Three people decide whether one booking turns into one visit.

Only one of them filled in your form. We have sorted them by the part each one plays in the decision. Age and postcode tell you nothing useful here.

The student who booked

They decide by picturing themselves there. They booked in a burst of motivation weeks ago, often several universities in one sitting.

- **What loses them:** they can no longer picture the day, and another university's day is easier to picture
- **What wins them:** their subject, their session and their time, written down for them

The person driving them

They decide by cost and effort. A parent, a carer or an older sibling gives up a Sunday and pays for the fuel or the train fares.

- **What loses them:** you have never asked them anything or sent them anything
- **What wins them:** their own reason to come, and their own thing to do while they are on campus

The one who went quiet

They decide by drift. They are still interested and no longer sure. They left your last two emails unopened and will leave a third unopened if it looks the same.

- **What loses them:** a reminder that repeats the booking confirmation back at them
- **What wins them:** a different format, plus an easy way to say "I cannot make this one, book me the next"

One detail decides this: the undergraduate open day runs on a **Sunday, 9.30am to 3pm**. A family has to negotiate that between them. We could not find a single piece of content on your site or in your live ads that speaks to the second person in that negotiation.

A booking is one name in a form. An attendance needs a lift, a Sunday morning and somebody else's agreement, and two of those three people have never heard from you.

Google and AI assistants cannot read your open day pages.

Event markup is the hidden code on a page that lets Google and an AI assistant state your date, your address and your booking link with confidence. These are the four open day pages on your site.

MIDDLESEX PAGE	EVENT MARKUP
/study/open-days/ (where every ad lands)	None
/study/open-days/programme/	None
/about-us/events/undergraduate-open-day/	Event, but broken
/about-us/events/postgraduate-open-event/	Event, but broken

What "broken" means here

The code gives your location as the words **"On campus"** instead of a real street address, and a partial page link instead of a full one. Google asks for a proper address, so your event cannot show up in the event results you want it in. A developer fixes this in an afternoon.

Nobody you compete with has fixed it either

We checked the open day landing pages of five universities you compete with directly. Four of them carry no event markup at all, and the fifth carries page markup only.

- Kingston · none
- Greenwich · none
- Hertfordshire · none
- Westminster · none
- Brunel · page markup only

Your written answers have the same problem

Your hub already answers "What happens at a university open day?", "What should I bring?" and "What's the best way to get to campus?" in plain English, and it answers them well. None of it is marked up as questions and answers. An assistant asked those same questions finds no Middlesex answer it can use, so it quotes forum threads instead.

A student or a parent asking an assistant "is the Middlesex open day worth going to" gets an answer built from forums. You can take that ground this term, before any of them do.

Every message tells them exactly how their Sunday is going to go.

Every university in this set promises an experience, and none of them promises a plan. No one has claimed the last row on this table, and Middlesex already publishes the schedule that backs it up.

WHAT THE CATEGORY SAYS	WHO OWNS IT	WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE
Come and see for yourself	Every university, Middlesex included	"Discover for yourself what it's like to be part of our community."
The rankings proof	Middlesex, heavily	"London's No.1 for Career Prospects", used word for word on postgraduate, Clearing and open day ads.
The facilities number	Middlesex and most rivals	"Experience £200m world-class facilities."
The campus film	Everyone	Drone shot, students walking, sunlight.
Knowing how your day will go	Open. Nobody.	"Your Sunday, in order: your session, your room, your time, the person you will meet, and how to get here."

Why this one holds

A rival cannot copy it in a week, because it is a schedule, a room list and a set of named people rather than a line of copy. They would have to build the operational detail first, and Middlesex has published all three of those already. It is also the only claim on this slide that speaks to the person driving.

How the rule decides what goes in each message

Every message has to answer one question: does this help them picture the day? A campus beauty shot does not. A station map with a walking time does. We would stop sending rankings claims recycled from Clearing, and stop sending "book now" to a person who has already booked.

Four emails and one text, sent one a week for five weeks.

We write all five. Each has one job, one format and one recipient, and each goes out on a set day counted back from the event. Email 2 is addressed to the parent, not to the student.

EMAIL 1

ON BOOKING · 5 WEEKS OUT

Make it real right away

A calendar file with the address already inside it, their subject session named, and one line on what they will be doing that day. This replaces "we will be in touch".

EMAIL 2

3 WEEKS OUT · TO THE PARENT

Ask the driver

A short note written to whoever is bringing them: parking, travel time, what there is for them between 10 and 3, and the two talks worth sitting in on.

EMAIL 3

2 WEEKS OUT

Put a face on it

Ninety seconds from the academic running their subject session, saying what they will be doing in that room. One person speaks to them from inside the building.

EMAIL 4

1 WEEK OUT

Hand over the running order

Their personal schedule: arrival, session, tour, the gap in the middle and what to do with it. Your schedule page, rewritten as one person's Sunday.

TEXT

THE DAY BEFORE

Clear the last excuses

Weather, trains, which door to walk in and who to look for. Plus a one-tap "I cannot make it, book me the next one" that keeps the relationship alive.

Who sends them

Your team does, out of GeckoEngage. We write the copy, build the calendar file and the running order, and specify the send triggers.

The mistake we avoid

Sending five versions of the same reminder. If two of the five could swap places without anyone noticing, we delete one of them.

Email 2 is the one nobody sends

Across the five universities we checked, we found no message written to the parent giving up their Sunday. They are the person who cancels the trip.

Judge this on show-up rate, or it gets cut in month two.

Booked against attended, event by event, against the same event last cycle. Every other number on this slide supports that one.

WHAT WE MEASURE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	HOW SOON
Show-up rate by event booked against attended	This is the one number that says whether the work paid off. Split it by undergraduate, postgraduate and campus tour.	One event cycle
Opens and clicks per message	This shows which of the five is working, so we can drop the ones that are not.	Weekly, in cycle
Attendees bringing someone	This tells you whether email 2, the one written to the driver, is working.	One event cycle
Attendee to application	This shows whether the extra attendees went on to apply.	One admissions cycle
Event markup validating	A yes or a no, and you can check it the day after it ships.	Within days

Why we ask for this number

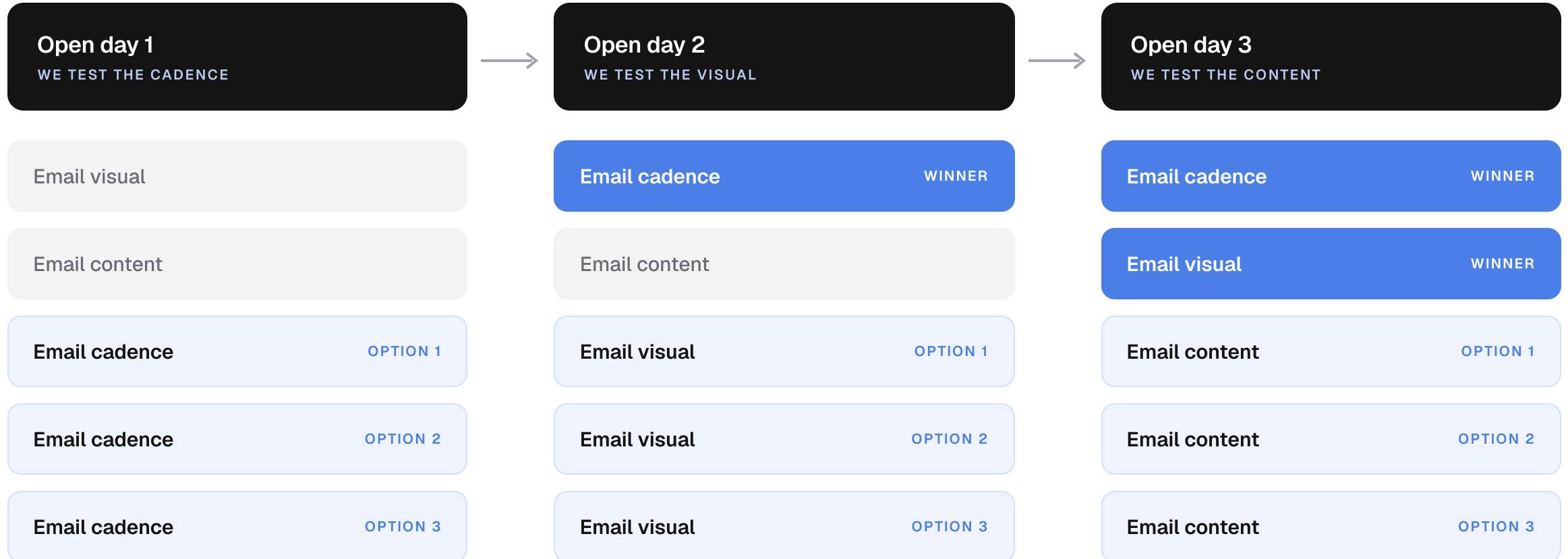
Judge this work on reach and it looks like a failure sitting next to a TikTok that did 1.2 million views. Somebody would then cut the five messages that fill the room. The comparison that counts is your own show-up rate, event against event, across the same period last cycle.

Where the numbers come from

All five come out of systems you already run: GeckoEngage bookings, your attendance scans and your admissions CRM. We would agree the baseline from your last three cycles before anything launches, so we settle the starting line before anything begins.

Email/CRM improvement iteration plan

We test one thing at each open day and keep the winner for the next one. Cadence goes first, then the visual, then the content.



What sits with us, and what stays with you.

We have set this out as inclusions and exclusions so there is no argument later about who owns what. We have left prices out on purpose. Fees follow once you agree the shape below.

In scope

- The four emails and the day-before text: concept, copy, art direction and production
- The calendar file and the one-page personal running order
- Moving the work you already own into the right message
- Filming on the day at the undergraduate and postgraduate events
- Content for attendees and for the people who booked and did not come
- The search and AI specification, plus a check that it shipped correctly
- Show-up reporting against your baseline, event by event

Not in scope

- **Media buying and paid social.** Your performance team keeps it. We do not touch the buy, the budget or the platforms.
- **Building the sends.** We write and specify all five. Your team or your vendor builds them in GeckoEngage.
- **Website development.** We write the markup specification. Your web team ships it.
- **The open day operation itself:** scheduling, staffing and rooms.
- **Ongoing organic social management.** We would propose that separately if you want it.

Your performance team gets the booking. We make sure the person who booked walks through the door on the day.